

VertiGO!!!

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 698 April 2007 PO BOX 1 6 2 8 W E L L I N G T O N

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea and coffee afterwards.

Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



2 April 2007 ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING – The Wellington Section's AGM is a once-a-year opportunity to hear a report on the last 12 months and vote on your favourite committee members! Garth promises it will be short and sweet (at the very least it'll be short) Then the real action starts! Short Talks is back for the first time in 2007. Come along and hear talks from Don French, Paul Grimwood and Louise Thornley on their summer (climbing) activities. If you have an adventure to skite about or you want to live vicariously through someone else's, don't miss this one!



Lendenfeld, Paul Grimwood



Section Trip News

Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

THE MONTH OF MOUNTAINEERING

Paul Mason started off his "Month of Mountaineering" with a crossing of the Southern Alps using Dennistoun Pass to get from the Whataroa & Perth Rivers to the Havelock River. Paul and his cousin took the opportunity to climb McClure Peak (2486m) on the trip.

Paul was then joined by Edwin Bryant and Don French (in support) and travelled further south. They deferred their approach to the wetter western objectives and tackled Eyre Peak (1968m), in the Eyre Mountains, just southwest of Queenstown. The route was via the Matarua River, and the curiously named "Bowels of the Earth". The major difficulties encountered were the matagarri and alpine scrub band. This turned into an 11½ hour day.

The three then moved onto the recently renovated Homer Hut in the Darrans. After a day of orientation and rescuing cars from flooded streams, they attempted Mt Talbot (2105m), via Homer Saddle, Talbot's Ladder, McPherson (1931 m). Their descent was via Traverse Col & Gertrude Saddle.

It was no mistake that they found themselves camping on a grassy flat at the head of Mistake Creek (head of the West Branch of the Eglington River) the next day. An early start saw the three climbing towards "U" pass, and crossing the Earl Mountains to the head waters of the Neale, and climbing Flat Top (2282m) via its west ridge. The climb had the spectacularly blue waters of Lake Erskine as a backdrop. The camp was reached at dusk after 14½ hours climbing.

Some inclement weather forced a return north for Don French, while the irrepressible two have headed to the Arrowsmith Range, and onto the Mt Cook region afterwards. Hopefully more will be known of their summit frenzy by our April meeting. So far their score stands at 5 summits in 2 weeks.

Don French

A FEW TRAMPING MISSIONS IN LIEU OF SNOW

In early February, Richard Davies and Hannah McGregor spent a week in the Red Hills/Cascade Coast area of South Westland. The Cascade was good travel, as was the route we took on to the Red Hills range. The weather was brilliant and a couple of nights were spent camped on the tops and Red Mountain was scrambled up for great views of the central Olivines and what felt like most of the Otago Alps and the Darrans. We returned to the Cascade via the Pyke valley, Big Bay and a visit to the Long family who live at Gorge river, with a final armpit deep crossing of the Cascade and a few bulls near Martyr homestead the last obstacles before the car.

In mid-February, Richard Davies, Hannah McGregor, Quentin Duthie (Canty/Westland section) and Andrew McCrorie headed up the Styx valley, after an abortive attempt to tag Newton and

Campbell bivvied on the way through we spent the night at Mudflats hut in the Arahura. From there the group ascended the old NZFS track directly behind the hut (a reasonable route, some markers remain) to the snowgrass basins of the Campbell Range. The ridge was gained at an easy unnamed saddle and from there traversed benches high above Julia Creek. A mixture of blocky scree and snowslopes led across to the point under Mt Axis. From there a short section of bad rock prevented them from linking with the standard route over Pope's Pass so we climbed up the remnant of the Axis glacier (these days just a small permanent snowfield) back to the top of the ridge from where the summit of Axis was a short rock scramble. From there it was straightforward to traverse the ridge top (lots of loose rock) to Mt Harman and descend to Browning Pass where they bivvied bagged. They then joined the hoards of Israelis and Germans and headed to Carrington via Browning, Whitehorn and Harman passes. Andrew and Quentin exited via the Waimak while Richard and Hannah went up to Waimakariri Col, then climbed to a higher col overlooking the head of Hunt's Creek and exited the hills via Hunt's Saddle and Kelly's Creek. You could do the 3 passes trip without an ice axe at the moment but crampons were required in the head of the Waimak and the Campbell Range.

Along with Ben Ainsworth, Hannah and Richard went and had a sniff around in the top of the Lawrence during some persistent grotty westerly weather and camped up on Butler saddle though they piked on the intended plan of looping back over McCoy Col - readers might like to note that the main flow of the Clyde was hard against the true left bank for much of the way from the Lawrence confluence to Erewhon requiring either a horrible sidle (there) or two tricky crossings (back), though it should be getting nice and low by now.

Richard also did a trip into the western bit of Nelson Lakes with Quentin Duthie, taking in the Nardoo tops, the top of the Matakītaki, a crossing of David Saddle and returned to the Matakītaki roadend via the Tiruamea river and Mole tops. Probably the only interest to club members is that the park is virtually snow free at the moment - just a couple of handkerchief sized patches visible on the Spensers.

Richard Davies

INSTRUCTING THE INSTRUCTORS...

Six geographically disparate members of the Alpine Club converged at Porter Lodge on Saturday 24th Feb to begin a week of Instruction lead by Paul Rogers and another of New Zealand's leading climbers, Johnny Davison. The students: Paul Grimwood (Wellington Section), Brandon Daniell (Auckland), Marcus Bai (Hamilton), Jerome Waldron (Nelson), Trevor Ingham (ChCh) and Dave Goodyear (Otago). Experience varied from AIC training on Ruapehu only, to those with a number of Southern Alps peaks under their belt.

By and large the weather behaved itself and we were able to fly up to Pioneer hut on the Monday morning – only a day late. The initial down time was put to good use with some crevasse rescue rope technique at Porter lodge. Once at Pioneer we lowered ourselves down a crevasse and tested these skills. Over the course of the first two days at Pioneer we also covered ice axe arrest in various positions, a range of snow/ice anchors, reading of the glacial terrain and belay techniques, thus covering a core set of mountaineering skills. The following day we applied these skills on an ascent of Lendenfeld Peak. We then journeyed down to Chancellor Hut and flew back to Fox Township. On the final day we practiced ice climbing and v-threads on the lower Fox glacier.

Having been advertised as 'This is not for the beginner' and applicants must be 'Extremely Fit' I had imagined we were going to be having some full-on days and climbing some challenging peaks. In reality, the days were quite tame and the climbing easy. The strength of the course lay instead in the teaching of fundamental alpine skills. I will take away with me a better understanding of:

1. The importance of using snow anchors well: keeping the pull forces in the appropriate direction and keeping shock loading to an absolute minimum through careful belaying or abseiling.
2. The use of the Munter hitch for bringing up the second.
3. Equalising anchors by tying a couple of knots either side of the apex rather than a loop (see photograph).
4. The solidity of V-threads and snow bollards.
5. How the peak of a glacier hat can prevent downward vision when one is stuck in a very tight crevasse (imagine a woodpecker).
6. Ice-climbing skills – a focus on the triangle formed by both feet and central pick placements. Make each placement solid – if you are not totally sure of the placement try again. Place those screws at hip height while hanging relaxed and straight-armed off the bomber axe placement.
7. In the right snow, snow pigs work extremely well.



The course is highly subsidised by the Alpine Club and I was further assisted by an award from the Distaghil Sar Fund. I am grateful for this opportunity to enhance my skills and hope I will be able to transfer some of my new knowledge to my students on this and subsequent AICs. I recommend it to anyone with a year or two's experience who is about to become an instructor or assistant instructor on the AIC.

Paul Grimwood

PSST! IT'S TRUE ABOUT THE POWDER IN JAPAN...

During the course of a downhill ski holiday in Hokkaido Carol Kelly, Joanna Poole and John Nankervis spent a couple of days ski touring in Daisetsuzan National Park, the volcanic mountain spine of Japan's northern island. The snow was deep, the weather occasionally fine (meaning not snowing) and those onsen (natural hot baths) in superb mountain settings hard to avoid.

John Nankervis



39 Mercer Street, PO Box 1560, Wellington, New Zealand
Ph/Fax (04) 4735353 email mainly.tramping@paradise.net.nz



GEAR PERSON WANTED/NEEDED

The Club has a considerable amount of club gear (ropes, harnesses, helmets etc) available to members for club trips and for use during instruction courses. We currently need someone to take over the role of gear person for the Wellington Section. This is an important way of supporting our members so if you are looking for a way to contribute to the club, then this could be the opportunity you've been looking for. You will need to have a good storage space suitable for this gear and be responsible for lending gear out and making sure that it is safely returned.

If you're interested, please contact Garth London on gl@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

**Shed 6 Queens Wharf
Wellingtons Waterfront
Ph 04 4998898 Fax 04 4998896
wn@fergskayaks.co.nz
www.fergskayaks.co.nz**

Open 7 Days

Largest Real Rock Indoor Rock Wall – Kayaking – Inline Skates - Retail - Rental

Alpine Club Members with card can climb anytime for \$8.
Monday nights show your members card and climb for \$5.



BANFF 2007

Banff 2007 is nearly here!

A great set of movies this year with a real mountaineering and climbing slant. Lots of spot prizes.

Tickets will be on sale from the start of April in the normal places:

- Mountain Designs
- Mainly Tramping

- Bivouac
- April Section night
- via the web by sending an email to md@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

The program this year is two nights, with distinct movies on each night. You have to attend both nights to see all the movies.

When: 6:30 pm start Thursday April 26 and Tuesday May 1

Where: Paramount Theatre

Promo video online: <http://www.youtube.com/v/qp2Q4V4vn8s>

Program Details: www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz/banff (from May 1)

Price: \$15 per evening. NZAC members pay \$12 ONLY if they purchase tickets from section night or via the web quoting your membership number. THE STORES WILL NOT GIVE YOU A DISCOUNT.

Be quick not to miss out.



ALPINE INSTRUCTION COURSE 2007

It's coming up to that time of year again – we are running the ever popular annual Alpine Instruction Course, and are taking names of interested people. More details to come...But to find out more and/or book a place on the course, call Rachael on 494 5643, or email rs@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



WORK AVOIDANCE

Richard Thomson responded to my call for trip reports by telling me, 'yes Rach, I have been sitting on my chuff but I'm off to the Darrans at the end of the month.' So we can expect some great reports from Richard soon, but in the meantime, he's alerted me to the fact that the American Alpine Club journal is now online. "It works really well and I've wasted far too much time browsing there already!" says Richard.

So...check it out: www.americanalpineclub.org/AAJO



A WORD FROM MADAM PREZ: NZAC AND DOC

NZAC enjoys a good relationship with DOC, especially in the context of alpine huts, and we should make sure we keep the relationship going by doing what they expect from us.

For instance, here's their rules about bolting in Tongariro National Park:

1. Further formal bolting only on sites with existing climbs, in particular Meads Wall and Mangatepopo Valley
2. Informal bolting is not permitted, and DOC will be seeking bylaws "to achieve certainty in this matter" in the coming year.
3. Cleaning climbs by removing vegetation is not permitted.
4. When requests are made to bolt or re-bolt routes, DOC will consult with NZAC before making a decision - which will depend on existing levels of site disturbance, the potential for fixing up previous rock-climbing activities, and the availability of other routes on the Plateau.

Bolters please note - before we lend you the section drill we'll get your commitment to these rules!

In all kinds of ways DOC is a major player in our access to crags and mountains and our enjoyment of them. The best way for NZAC to be involved in their decision-making process is to for members to get on to Conservation Boards in their areas. Nominations were called for in March this year, and the closing date is 2 APRIL. Not much time - but if you are interested phone Katrina Edwards at DOC 04 471 3289, or contact her by email, kedwards@doc.govt.nz. You can self-nominate, but better to get your section's support - talk to Garth London or Judy Reid.'



Wellington Section Photo Competition 2007 – Enter Now



**Last Year's Overall
Champion**

'On the Shoulder'

Tom Wilson

The annual Wellington Section photo competition is on again. Shaun Barnett will again be judging. Shaun is well known for his outdoor photography and is a former editor of *Wilderness* Magazine.

Pit your photos against the best.

Learn how to improve your photographic skills.

Entries close Friday 1 June 2007

Judging and prizegiving will take place at our [club meeting](#) on **Monday 11 June 2007**.

And as usual we'll be pulling together a great set of prizes.

Pick out your best slides and digital pics and fit them into one of the following categories: *Alpine Activity

*Alpine General *Alpine Nature
*Rockclimbing *Photo Journalism *Humour

Drop off your entries together with entry form at either of:

- Mainly Tramping at Grand Arcade Willis St
- Bivouac Outdoor at 39 Mercer St
- Mountain Designs at 78 Mercer St

If you have digitals, you can email them to james.wright@xtra.co.nz

Entry forms can be downloaded off the web site or alternatively are available at all the drop off points.

For further information contact James Wright at (04) 232-7748, (027) 4725-561

Or refer to the Wellington Section website at www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Prizes kindly donated by:



Notice from HQ...

Notice for Westpac Customers

Just to let you know that the New Zealand Alpine Club bank account is now set up as a payee on Westpac's phone and online banking services.

If you are a Westpac customer you will be able to pay the NZAC for membership

renewals, etc either:

- for phone banking, call Westpac on 0800 400 600 with their Customer ID and phone password, or
- for online banking, logon through the website at <http://www.westpac.co.nz> and select the 'set up

someone new to pay online' link

Customers can then make one-off payments as required. They will incur an electronic transaction

charge, at the rate applicable to their account.

If you wish to take advantage of this electronic system, please remember to enter

Particulars: Surname and Initials

Code: Invoice or Membership number e.g Member no. 007

Reference: What the payment is for e.g Annual Sub

We will let you know if we are able to extend this service to other major banks in the future.



FOR SALE/WANTED TO BUY

For Sale: Ski touring package. Ski's Rossi Bandit XX 191cm with Diamir Titanal 2 bindings and brakes, profile cut Montana Skins, Scarpa Denali XT

(blue) boots with re-mouldable Intuition liners, suit sizes 10-13 approx.

All in good condition. \$620 ono. Phone Matt 03 337 8018 or 027 688 7537"



AND HERE ARE THE CLUB TRIPS

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, come and chat to Caroline Hart (trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going.

Trips for the Calendar for 2007 so far...

Aconcagua : 2007

The highest mountain in the Southern Hemisphere and outside Asia is the perfect choice to take your high altitude trekking to the next level. I'm organizing an Aconcagua expedition on 11-12/2007 and I'm looking for people to join the core group to work out the details during the next few months.

The expedition will be as independent as possible and guided or unguided depending on the route choice. Climbing Aconcagua does not necessarily require technical climbing skills but experience in high altitude trekking and fitness is required as the goal is not to use external help beyond the base camp. Later, when the exact budget, date, route and timetable have been set the expedition will be open for any club members to join.

Especially for those who aim on taking eight thousanders later Aconcagua is extremely good practice. I am also considering combining an acclimatisation trip to the Cotopaxi (and possibly the other volcanos there) in Ecuador just before the expedition. Please contact me through email

at jsarkila@gmail.com for more information and visit www.aconcagua.com for general information

about the mountain.

Juho Sarkila, Wellington

Nepal – depart NZ late April 2007.

We are looking for additional people keen to go to Nepal – either for a trekking holiday or to climb Island Peak.

Sherpa Kamal Rai and his wife Sara are facilitating the above trip to Nepal, working with Adventure Travel. So far there are 3 adults + 18 mth old child in the trekking group and 3 adults in the climbing group. We currently have space for 3-4 trekkers and 1-3 climbers.

Guided Camping Trek 1 : Everest Base Camp and Island Peak (20 days).

Challenging, limited technical climb. Approx NZ\$5,200

Guided Camping Trek 2 : Sherpa Villages (17 days). Easy. Approx NZ \$4,800

Prices include: return airfares, taxes, accommodation in Thailand and Nepal, food, internal airfares, climbing permits

For further information contact: Sara and Kamal Rai 04 528 3814, 021 747 994

Waypoint Adventures www.go2nepal.com



MOVED HOUSE?

Please notify the Club's National Administrator of your change of address as the labels for all newsletters and club publications are generated at the HQ office.

You can contact:

Margaret McMahon
National Administrator
email office@alpineclub.org.nz

NZAC
PO BOX 786
CHRISTCHURCH
TEL (03) 377 7595
FAX (03) 337 7594



Bored at work?

Check out www.mountainz.co.nz

<http://www.geonet.org.nz/taranaki.html>

Central NI Volcanoes from Taupo

<http://www.taupodc.govt.nz/AboutTaupoDistrict/WebCam.htm>

Mount Ngauruhoe

<http://www.geonet.org.nz/ngauruhoe.html>

Mount Ruapehu – from Chateau

<http://www.geonet.org.nz/ruapehu.html>

Mount Ruapehu – from Ohakune

<http://www.unique-art-gallery.com/gallery/webcam1.htm>

Tararuas from Wellington

<http://www.wn.co.nz/cameras/cam01.php>

Nelson Lakes

<http://www.snow.co.nz/clients/nelsonlakes/webcam.asp>

Castle Hill Basin

<http://www.castlehill.net.nz/webcam.htm>

Mt Cook

<http://www.alpineguides.co.nz/popup/cam.htm>

Two Thumb range & Multi Brun (east)

<http://www.tekapotourism.com/webcam.htm>

Aspiring

http://www.lakewanaka.co.nz/index.cfm/web_cam/

Queenstown

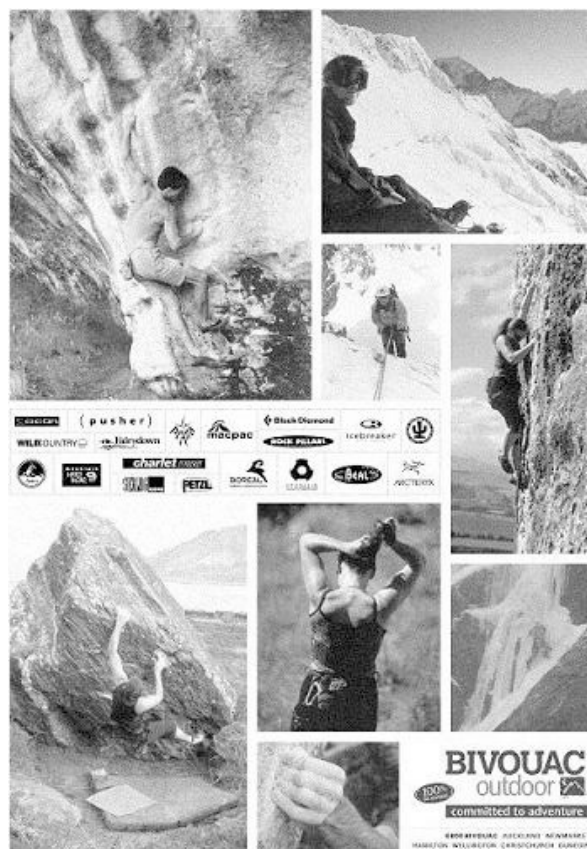
<http://www.skyline.co.nz/queenstown/webcam/>

Scott Base

<http://www.antarcticanz.govt.nz/education/2568>

Allsorts of others at

<http://www.enzed.com/cam.html>

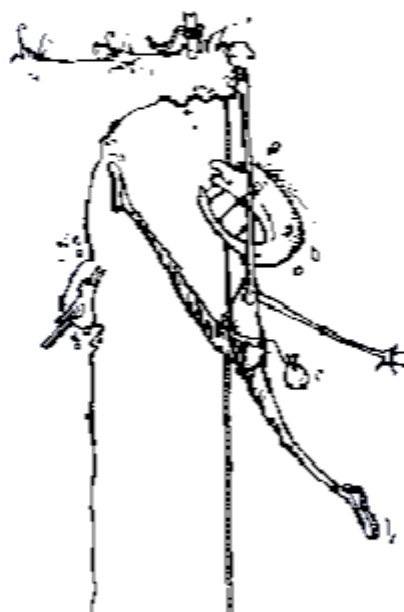




Wellington Section Directory: 2007 contact list

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Patron			
Chairperson	Garth London	CHAIRPERSON <i>or</i> GL	(04) 479 2984
Vice Chairperson	Pete de Joux	PD	N/A
Secretary	Rachel Depree	SECRETARY <i>or</i> RD	N/A
Treasurer	Karen Domaneschi	TREASURER <i>or</i> KD	N/A
National Rep	Garth London	GL	(04) 479 2984
Instruction: AIC	Rachael Schmidt	RS <i>or</i> AIC	(04) 494 5643
Instruction: RIC	Blair Hiscoke	SPRINGROCK	N/A
Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	KF	N/A
Trips	Caroline Hart	TRIPS <i>or</i> CD	N/A
	Jen Brown	Trips <i>or</i> JB	027 292 0903
Library	Derek Richardson	LIBRARY	N/A
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	(04) 934 7926
Committee Members	Hayden Cox	HC	(04) 976 3365
	Paul Grimwood	PG	N/A
	Andrew MacIntosh	AM	N/A
	Amanda Redvers	AR	N/A
	Dave Shanks	DS	N/A
	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
Newsletter Editor	Rachael Schmidt	NEWSLETTER <i>or</i> RS	(04) 474 5643
Webmeister	Jane Furkert	WEBMASTER <i>or</i> JF	N/A
National President	Judy Reid	JR	N/A

* Email address is alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, eg: secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



If undelivered please return to:

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